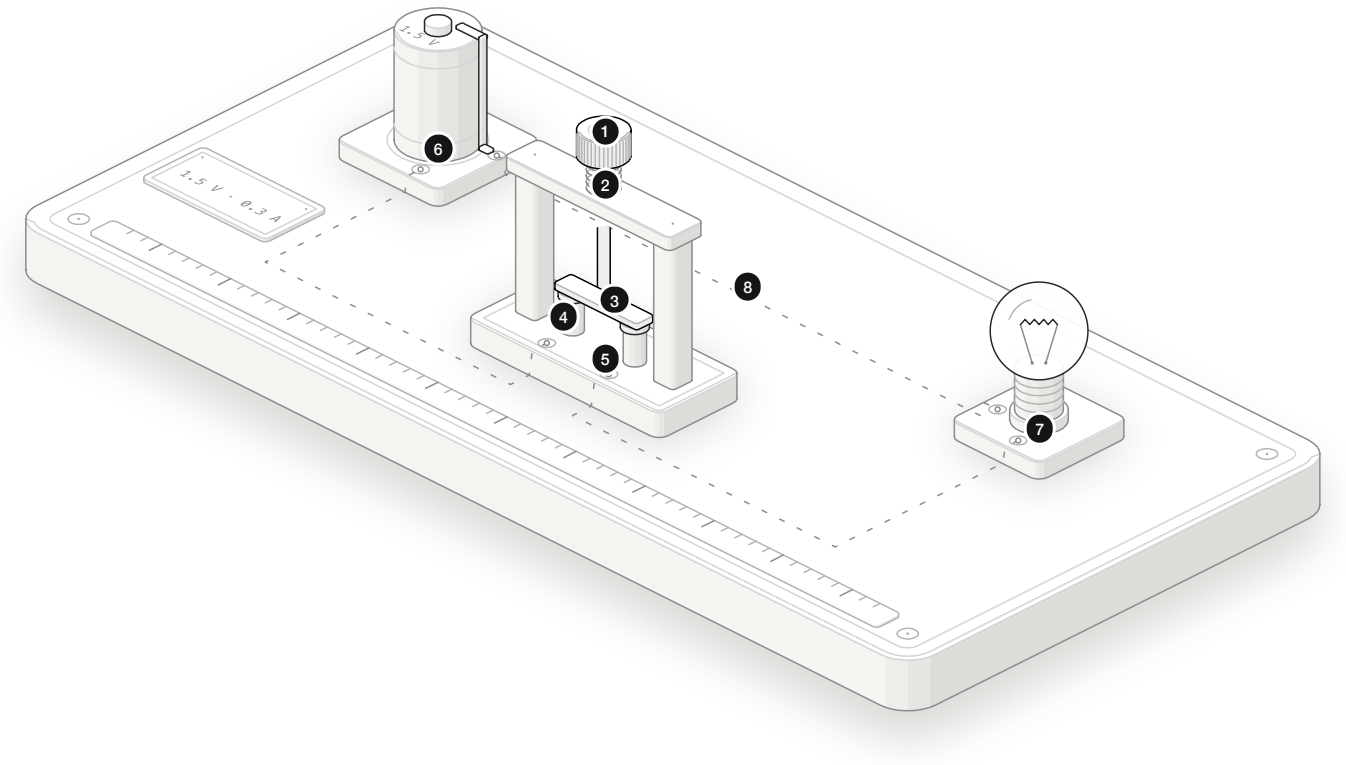
Push button

CW–003
HOW IT WORKS
A LOOP, A GAP AND A SPRING



How does pressing a button turn a light on?

Current only flows round a closed loop. The button is a gap in the loop that a spring holds open: press it and the gap closes, let go and it opens again.

1.5 V
FROM THE CELL

0.30 A
ROUND THE CLOSED LOOP

0.45 W
IN THE BULB

7 px
GAP THE BRIDGE CLOSES

01 **Cap**
The knurled button you press; it carries the plunger.

02 **Return spring**
Squeezed by a press, it lifts the plunger again on release.

03 **Copper bridge**
A bar on the plunger that joins the two posts.

04 **Contact posts**
Two brass posts, one wired to each side of the gap.

05 **Frame**
An insulating base and an open frame that guide the plunger.

06 **Cell**
A 1.5 V cell in a holder that pushes the current.

07 **Bulb**
A filament in a glass globe that glows when current flows.

08 **Wires**
Three runs that join cell, bulb and switch in one loop.